TRI-STATE SALARY GUIDE 2027

# Technology & Digital salaries for 2027

What employers in New York, New Jersey and Connecticut are paying, so you can plan 2027 hiring with confidence.

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vacobyhighspring.github.io/solutions/salary-guide

SALARIES BY ROLE

# Base salary by role

Typical 2027 base salary in New York, by experience level. Individual roles show Early career (1 to 3 years), Experienced (4 to 6 years) and Senior (7+ years). Manager, director and executive roles show the lower range, typical pay and upper range, because their pay moves with company size and scope. New Jersey and Connecticut usually pay a little less; see Pay by location.

| Role | Early career / Lower range | Experienced / Typical | Senior / Upper range |
|---|---|---|---|
| **SOFTWARE ENGINEERING** | | | |
| Software Engineer | $138,000 | **$171,000** | $202,000 |
| Software Architect | $159,000 | **$195,000** | $237,000 |
| Software Engineering Manager | $182,000 | **$217,000** | $289,000 |
| Director of Engineering | $180,000 | **$227,000** | $294,000 |
| VP of Technology / Engineering | $209,000 | **$250,000** | $269,000 |
| **QA & TESTING** | | | |
| QA / Test Automation Engineer | $104,000 | **$124,000** | $148,000 |
| QA Manager | $110,000 | **$140,000** | $161,000 |
| **CLOUD, DEVOPS, PLATFORM & SRE** | | | |
| Cloud & DevOps Engineer | $130,000 | **$157,000** | $182,000 |
| Release Manager | $104,000 | **$139,000** | $177,000 |
| **DATA & AI** | | | |
| Data Analyst | $81,000 | **$95,000** | $132,000 |
| Database Administrator | $93,000 | **$127,000** | $157,000 |
| Data Engineer | $127,000 | **$154,000** | $175,000 |
| Data Scientist | $108,000 | **$144,000** | $179,000 |
| AI Engineer | $108,000 | **$149,000** | $183,000 |
| Analytics Manager | $114,000 | **$126,000** | $173,000 |
| Director of Data & Analytics | $165,000 | **$209,000** | $260,000 |
| **CYBERSECURITY** | | | |
| Security Operations (SOC) Analyst | $84,000 | **$121,000** | $148,000 |
| GRC Analyst | $116,000 | **$128,000** | $159,000 |
| Security Engineer | $116,000 | **$149,000** | $191,000 |
| Security Architect | $159,000 | **$192,000** | $237,000 |
| Information Security Manager | $182,000 | **$228,000** | $303,000 |
| Director of Information Security | $180,000 | **$222,000** | $281,000 |

| Role | Early career / Lower range | Experienced / Typical | Senior / Upper range |
|---|---|---|---|
| VP of Information Security | $244,000 | **$313,000** | $371,000 |
| Chief Information Security Officer | $228,000 | **$276,000** | $339,000 |
| **ERP & CRM** | | | |
| ERP / Enterprise Systems Analyst | $95,000 | **$121,000** | $158,000 |
| CRM Administrator / Developer | $104,000 | **$136,000** | $159,000 |
| Enterprise Systems Administrator | $119,000 | **$141,000** | $164,000 |
| ERP / Enterprise Systems Developer | $131,000 | **$149,000** | $172,000 |
| ERP Consultant | $110,000 | **$136,000** | $161,000 |
| ERP Manager | $182,000 | **$228,000** | $303,000 |
| **IT, INFRASTRUCTURE & SERVICE DESK** | | | |
| Service Desk Analyst | $58,000 | **$70,000** | $74,000 |
| Systems Administrator / Engineer | $102,000 | **$128,000** | $144,000 |
| Network Engineer | $116,000 | **$129,000** | $159,000 |
| Help Desk Manager | $96,000 | **$112,000** | $145,000 |
| IT Infrastructure Manager | $120,000 | **$147,000** | $170,000 |
| Director of Infrastructure | $167,000 | **$207,000** | $264,000 |
| **PRODUCT & DELIVERY** | | | |
| Business Analyst | $94,000 | **$125,000** | $160,000 |
| Project Manager | $114,000 | **$143,000** | $157,000 |
| Product Manager | $155,000 | **$184,000** | $191,000 |
| Program Manager | $126,000 | **$129,000** | $192,000 |
| Agile Coach | $137,000 | **$166,000** | $192,000 |
| Director of Product | $193,000 | **$199,000** | $283,000 |
| PMO Director | $166,000 | **$206,000** | $264,000 |
| **UX & DESIGN** | | | |
| UI/UX Designer | $104,000 | **$116,000** | $145,000 |
| UX Researcher | $100,000 | **$131,000** | $178,000 |
| Product Designer | $101,000 | **$127,000** | $178,000 |
| **ARCHITECTURE** | | | |
| Solutions Architect | $138,000 | **$172,000** | $198,000 |
| Enterprise Architect | $156,000 | **$182,000** | $209,000 |
| **TECHNOLOGY LEADERSHIP** | | | |
| IT Director | $159,000 | **$178,000** | $216,000 |

| Role | Early career / Lower range | Experienced / Typical | Senior / Upper range |
|---|---|---|---|
| **VP of Product** | $166,000 | **$207,000** | $254,000 |
| **VP of Information Technology** | $202,000 | **$223,000** | $229,000 |
| **Chief Technology Officer** | $183,000 | **$249,000** | $318,000 |
| **Chief Information Officer** | $189,000 | **$255,000** | $321,000 |
| **Chief Data Officer** | $198,000 | **$265,000** | $356,000 |

PAY BY INDUSTRY AND LOCATION

# Where pay runs higher or lower

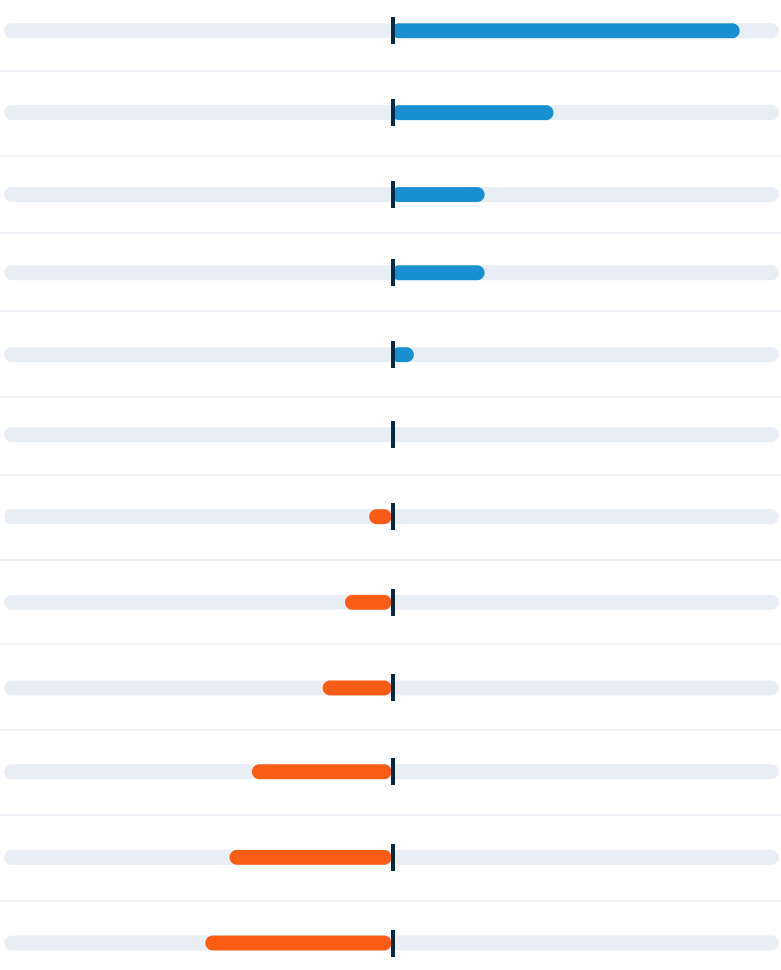
Each figure compares base salary in job postings from the last six months with the tri-state market for the same roles. The example shows what a $100,000 role would pay.

## By location



| | | |
|---|---|---|
| New York City | 5% above market | $100,000 role ≈ $105,000 |
| Long Island | In line with market | $100,000 role ≈ $100,000 |
| Westchester and Hudson Valley | 4% below market | $100,000 role ≈ $96,000 |
| New Jersey | 5% below market | $100,000 role ≈ $95,000 |
| Connecticut | 5% below market | $100,000 role ≈ $95,000 |

## By industry



| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Fintech | 15% above market | $100,000 role ≈ $115,000 |
| Hedge funds and asset management | 7% above market | $100,000 role ≈ $107,000 |
| Technology | 4% above market | $100,000 role ≈ $104,000 |
| Professional services | 4% above market | $100,000 role ≈ $104,000 |
| Banking and capital markets | 1% above market | $100,000 role ≈ $101,000 |
| Insurance | In line with market | $100,000 role ≈ $100,000 |
| Manufacturing and industrial | 1% below market | $100,000 role ≈ $100,000 |
| Healthcare and life sciences | 2% below market | $100,000 role ≈ $98,000 |
| Consumer, retail and hospitality | 3% below market | $100,000 role ≈ $97,000 |
| Real estate and construction | 6% below market | $100,000 role ≈ $94,000 |
| Media, entertainment and sports | 7% below market | $100,000 role ≈ $93,000 |
| Nonprofit, education and government | 8% below market | $100,000 role ≈ $92,000 |

BONUS AND EQUITY

# What employers pay on top of salary

### Almost every company has a bonus plan

Share of companies with a yearly bonus plan (short-term incentive) for at least some employees. Not every role is eligible.




### Equity plans are standard at public companies

Share of companies with an equity or multi-year cash plan (long-term incentive) for at least some employees




### Public companies are twice as likely to give managers equity

Share of companies that give managers a long-term incentive




## How bonuses are structured

ANNUAL BONUS

**Plan on a bonus of about 10% to 25% of salary.**

About 10% of salary for early-career engineers, about 15% for engineering managers, about 20% for senior engineers and about 25% for senior managers

WHO HAS A FORMAL PLAN

**Public tech companies are far more likely to have a set bonus plan.**

74% of public tech companies and 44% of private ones have a formal bonus plan for individual contributors

SPOT BONUSES

**About a third also pay one-off spot bonuses.**

About a third of tech companies also pay spot bonuses to individual contributors, public and private alike

## How equity is structured

PUBLIC COMPANIES

**Expect stock units, often with performance shares.**

Restricted stock units (90% of public companies) and performance shares (74%).

STARTUPS

**Stock options, earned over four years.**

Stock options that vest monthly or quarterly after a one-year cliff, usually over four years. Ask about refresh grants: without them, equity runs out after year four

PRIVATE EQUITY-BACKED

**A slice of a pool of about 10% of the company, paid at a sale.**

Profits interests (50%), stock options (30%) or restricted shares (28%), from a pool of about 10% of the company. Most plans tie at least part of the award to the sale multiple

## Building your offer

- Ask what the candidate leaves behind: unvested stock and this year's bonus. A sign-on bonus or a larger first-year grant is the usual way to cover it.
- Quote total compensation (base, target bonus and yearly equity value), not base alone. Tech candidates compare offers that way.
- At a startup, put the vesting schedule, cliff and refresh policy in writing. Candidates discount equity they do not understand.

## What leaders can expect on top of salary

| | |
|---|---|
| **IT Director** | Expect a cash bonus of $5K to $45K in New York. Equity comes mainly at public companies as stock units; at PE-backed companies it is small below the C-suite. |
| **Chief Information Officer** | Total pay runs about 13% above base. Equity is likely at public and PE-backed companies, and much less common at other private companies. |
| **Chief Technology Officer** | At startups the equity matters more than the bonus. At PE-backed companies expect around half a percent of the company, paid out at the sale. |
| **Chief Information Security Officer** | Most CISOs get equity; at banks and tech companies total pay runs far above salary. |
| **VP of Engineering** | A modest cash bonus; the real lever is stock. Ask how refresh grants work, since they decide pay after year two. |
| **Engineering Manager** | Banks pay more in bonus, tech companies more in stock. Compare total pay, not base. |
| **Senior and staff software engineers** | Senior pay in New York runs $180K to $365K in total (middle half). The mix varies by employer: stock at tech companies, bonus at banks and trading firms. |

PERKS AND BENEFITS

# Perks that win offers

How common each perk is, and which ones set you apart.

**57%**

FLEXIBILITY

### Hybrid is getting rarer, so it stands out more

SHRM's 2026 Employee Benefits Survey found 57% of employers offer hybrid work, down from 63%. Offering it is becoming a point of difference.

**27%**

FLEXIBILITY

### Try a work-from-anywhere window

SHRM reported 27% of employers began offering limited-time work-from-anywhere arrangements in 2026, a lower-commitment way to add flexibility.

**30%**

FLEXIBILITY

### A four-day week is the top return-to-office incentive

In FlexJobs' survey, 30% of workers named a four-day workweek as the perk that would persuade them to return to the office full time, ahead of a raise of 15% or more (18%).

**46%**

FAMILY

### Paid parental leave is spreading fast

SHRM's 2026 survey of 5,472 organizations found 46% now offer paid parental leave, up seven points in a year. Paid prenatal leave beyond legal requirements rose from 10% to 18%.

**50%**

FAMILY

### Fertility and family-building coverage

Mercer found IVF coverage is now offered by 50% of large employers, and by 77% of those with 20,000 or more employees.

**81%**

MONEY

### The 401(k) match is expected

SHRM's 2026 survey found 90% of employers offer a traditional 401(k) and 81% of them match contributions. The average maximum match is 6.11%.

**10%**

MONEY

### Student loan help is still rare

SHRM found company-provided student loan repayment grew from 8% to 10% of employers, with the average tuition or loan repayment maximum rising to $5,546. A rare benefit is a memorable one.

**33%**

GROWTH

### Paid AI tools are the fastest-growing perk

Employer-sponsored AI tool subscriptions jumped 17 percentage points to 33% of employers in SHRM's 2026 survey.

**49%**

HEALTH

### Weight-loss drug coverage divides employers

Mercer found 49% of large employers covered GLP-1 drugs for weight loss, though 6% dropped coverage in 2026. Across employers of all sizes, SHRM found only 15% cover them for weight management.

2027 OUTLOOK

# Technology & Digital hiring in 2027

The numbers that matter for 2027 hiring.

## In demand for 2027

**+88%**

### AI roles are growing five times faster

Dice's September 2026 Jobs Report found AI and machine learning tech postings grew 88% year over year, about five times the 17% growth for tech postings overall.

**75%**

### AI fluency is now a baseline ask

According to Dice's July 2026 Jobs Report, 75% of US technology openings required AI fluency in June, up 178% from a year earlier.

**+638%**

### Integration skills lead the growth list

Dice reported enterprise integration skills grew 638% from June 2025 to June 2026, the largest rise of any skill. Vector databases (353%), prompt engineering (253%) and observability (251%) followed.

**56%**

### Data and security lead 2027 hiring plans

In Gartner's CIO planning research for 2027, the greatest hiring demand is projected in data and analytics (56%) and cybersecurity (54%).

**+47%**

### Banks are hiring tech talent fastest

Dice found tech job postings in finance and banking rose 47% year over year, against 23% for tech postings overall. Roles with AI in the title rose 173% in the first quarter of 2026 while software development postings dipped 22%.

## Where employers are investing

**+55.5%**

### AI infrastructure takes the biggest share

Gartner forecasts data center systems spending of $1.37 trillion in 2027, up 55.5%, the fastest growth of any IT segment, driven by AI infrastructure.

**+14.6%**

### Software budgets keep climbing

Gartner expects software spending to reach nearly $1.68 trillion in 2027, up 14.6%, as AI is built into existing applications and platforms.

**1 in 2**

### AI is the top investment priority

McKinsey's Global Tech Agenda 2026 found AI has passed cybersecurity and infrastructure modernization as companies' top investment area for the next two years. Half of all companies name it a priority.

**$86B**

### Security for AI is its own budget line

Gartner forecasts worldwide AI cybersecurity spending of about $86 billion in 2027, up from about $51 billion in 2026.

**52%**

### Data and security get the dollars

In Gartner's C-level community survey, more than half of IT leaders (52%) plan to invest in data and analytics and 47% in cybersecurity in 2026.

## What happened in 2026

**2.8%**

### Tech unemployment stayed well below the national rate

CompTIA put the IT unemployment rate at 2.8% in October 2026, versus 4.1% for all workers. Tech occupations across the economy added about 26,000 jobs that month.

**+22.2%**

### Job postings climbed back

Employers added 290,892 new tech job postings in October 2026, up 22.2% from October 2025. Software developers and engineers led with 51,944 new postings.

**62%**

### AI skills carry a large pay premium

PwC's 2026 Global AI Jobs Barometer found jobs requiring AI skills advertise a 62% wage premium, up from 57% a year earlier. Postings requiring AI skills grew 69%, versus 9% overall.

**171,501**

### Layoffs and hiring at the same time

Challenger, Gray & Christmas counted 171,501 announced technology-sector job cuts through October 2026, the most of any industry. Postings still rose, so cuts and hiring are happening side by side.

**366,322**

### Infrastructure, security and data roles grew fastest

CompTIA reported double-digit monthly growth in October 2026 postings for DevOps engineers, infrastructure architects, cybersecurity engineers and data scientists. Active postings asking for AI skills reached 366,322.

**48%**

### NYC tech teams are still mostly hybrid

In Hubble's survey of 126 NYC startup leaders, 48% run hybrid, 43% fully remote and 9% fully in-office. Only 4% of remote or hybrid leaders plan a five-day return.

## What 2027 looks like

**3.7%**

### Tech raises budgeted slightly above average

The Conference Board projects a 3.5% median US salary increase budget for 2027. Tech, telecom and information services lead at a 3.7% median.

**3.2%**

### Merit budgets hold steady

Mercer's July 2026 QuickPulse survey of 1,001 US employers projects 3.5% total increase budgets and 3.2% merit budgets for 2027.

**+15%**

### IT spending set to jump

Gartner forecasts worldwide IT spending will reach $7.35 trillion in 2027, up 15% from 2026, the first time it crosses $7 trillion.

**37%**

### Employers still plan to add tech staff

ManpowerGroup's Experis survey put the US tech Net Employment Outlook for Q4 2026 at 37%, down 10 points from a year earlier. Hiring intent is positive but more selective.

**36%**

### Overall hiring intent is solid

ManpowerGroup's US Net Employment Outlook for Q4 2026 is 36%. The Q1 2027 survey had not been released as of this guide's research date.

## What managers need to know

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **Oct 1** | **Connecticut now requires pay ranges in postings** | From October 1, 2026, Connecticut employers of any size must post a good-faith wage range and a benefits description. This also covers remote roles reporting to a Connecticut supervisor or worksite. |
| **Yearly** | **AI screening tools in NYC need a bias audit** | NYC Local Law 144 requires an annual independent bias audit, a posted audit summary and candidate notice before using automated hiring tools. A December 2025 state audit pushed NYC to tighten enforcement. |
| **Dec 15** | **New Jersey targets biased hiring algorithms** | New Jersey disparate-impact rules effective December 15, 2025 name automated decision-making tools as a source of liability. Employers should be able to show how they tested screening tools for bias. |
| **39 days** | **Plan for about six weeks to fill a role** | SHRM's 2026 benchmarking data shows a median time-to-fill of 39 calendar days for nonexecutive positions, down from last year. Executive cost-per-hire rose substantially. |
| **3 states** | **Noncompete bans are stalled, for now** | As of April 2026, bills to restrict noncompetes in New York (S4641), New Jersey (S1407/A1829) and Connecticut (Raised Bill 5492) were pending. New York's bill would exempt earners of $500,000 or more. |

SOURCES AND METHOD

# Where the numbers come from

## Sources

- Vaco by Highspring internal data.
- Current data only. Every figure was published or collected in 2026. The one exception is the U.S. Dept. of Labor wage survey, whose latest release covers May 2025.
- U.S. Dept. of Labor (BLS Occupational Employment and Wage Statistics, May 2025): New York-Newark-Jersey City metro, plus New Jersey and Connecticut statewide.
- Job postings with posted salary ranges in New York, New Jersey and Connecticut, posted in the last six months (May 10 to November 10, 2026), from Google Jobs, company career sites and job boards.
- Salary sites: Glassdoor, PayScale, Salary.com, ZipRecruiter, Built In, Comparably and Levels.fyi, New York figures, collected November 2026.
- Bonus and long-term incentives: SEC proxy filings of public companies headquartered in the New York area, and published executive pay surveys.
- Total pay with bonus: Glassdoor and PayScale New York pages that publish both base and total pay, compared page by page.
- Perks and benefits:
- Market outlook:

## How the numbers are set

- Vaco by Highspring adjustment. Pay figures are adjusted using Vaco by Highspring's recruiting experience in the New York, New Jersey and Connecticut market.
- Vaco recommended offer (in each role card and the hiring advisor): a range from the typical figure up to about the 65th percentile (the typical figure plus 60% of the way to the upper end). Offers toward the top of the range win strong candidates in a competitive search. It is Vaco's advice, not a market average.
- Vaco by Highspring internal data counts twice and is never dropped as an outlier.
- Each source counts once, except Vaco internal data. The typical salary is the middle of the sources' typical figures; the range is the middle of their low and high figures (25th and 75th percentiles where published).
- Accounting and finance titles: Early career is the staff or analyst title, Experienced is the senior title (the 4 to 6 year job), Senior is the upper end of the senior title.
- Outlier rule: any source figure more than 15% below or 35% above the middle of all sources for that role is left out, so one site that reads far off the rest cannot pull a role down or up.
- Where a senior title was combined into its base role, the Experienced figure sits between the two titles, because senior is a matter of years, not a different job.
- Job postings: the middle of posted low and high ends, and of the midpoints. Duplicates, hourly and contract roles, and postings older than six months are excluded.
- Financial Services figures use postings from banks, insurers, investment firms and private equity, plus Vaco internal data. Accounting & Finance figures exclude those employers.
- New Jersey and Connecticut are compared with New York source by source: each source's state figure is set against the same source's New York figure for that role, and the typical gap is applied to the New York pay. Where a role has fewer than two matching sources, the state's typical gap to New York is used. A state is shown above New York only when the matching sources support it.
- Industry views use real pay data. Where a role has no figure of its own for an industry (too few postings of its own), it is estimated from how that industry pays for roles in the same skill area, or else for all roles. Estimates are labeled.
- Base annual salary unless stated. Bonus and equity figures are shown separately, with their sources.

TALK TO US

## Want help pricing a role?

Talk to your local Vaco team for role-specific data, who is available to hire now, and help building an offer that wins.

**vaco.com/contact-us**

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